BARNABÁS SZÉKELY

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Education

2020 – 2026 (expected)	**Graduate School of Economics, Finance and Management** Ph.D. in Economics	Frankfurt, Germany
2015 – 2016	**Barcelona School of Economics** Master's Degree in Applied Economic Analysis	Barcelona, Spain
2012 – 2015	**Eötvös Loránd University, Eltecon** Bachelor's Degree in Economics	Budapest, Hungary

Working Papers

Reorganizing Debt Finance: Cash Flow-Based Lending, Default Resolution and Credit Allocation
Job Market Paper

Abstract: This paper argues that high reorganization costs limit access to cash flow-backed borrowing, distort firm financing and depress aggregate productivity. I develop a general equilibrium model with heterogeneous firms that may borrow against physical assets or expected future cash flows and bankruptcy outcomes reflecting Chapter 7 (liquidation) and Chapter 11 (reorganization) of the U.S. bankruptcy code. Due to high reorganization costs, smaller firms are at an elevated risk of liquidation, which prevents them from credibly pledging future earnings as collateral. As a result, asset-poor firms are constrained by insufficient physical collateral on the one hand and elevated liquidation risk on the other. Calibrated to U.S. firm-level data, the model shows that reducing reorganization costs narrows the financing gap between small and large firms, and raises aggregate productivity by reallocating capital and promoting firm entry. These results highlight the benefits of a reorganization-friendly bankruptcy regime. Size-based reforms, such as the 2019 Small Business Reorganization Act, can generate substantial macroeconomic gains by improving small firms' access to external finance.

Funding for lending schemes should prioritize SME lending
MNB Occasional Papers 2020/138

Abstract: In the aftermath of the sovereign debt crisis, the Central Bank of Hungary implemented a great-scale fund-ing-for-lending scheme designed specifically to subsidize Small and Medium Enterprises' (SMEs) access to external finance. I identify this policy in the SVAR framework as asymmetric credit supply shocks specific to SME lending. During the post-crisis recovery, such shocks had a substantial, positive effect on lending conditions and the real economy. For a unit of lending, these shocks had a larger and more persistent effect on output than general credit supply shocks. Moreover, rather than supplanting lending to large enterprises, the program had considerable positive spillover effects on this sector as well. These results are robust to different proxies of economic performance and alternative identification strategies. I conclude that under tight lending conditions funding for lending schemes are more effective if concentrated to SMEs.

A Model-Based Comparision of Macroprudential Tools
MNB Working Papers, No. 2021/3, with Eyno Rots

Abstract: We develop a DSGE model to analyze a macroprudential policy framework. We use it to describe the Hungarian economy and the key regulatory constraints implemented there: the loan-to-value and the debt-service-to-income caps imposed on mortgage borrowers and the minimum capital requirement imposed on banks. Our model is novel in the way it treats the borrowing caps as soft constraints, which makes it easy to analyze multiple non-redundant borrowing constraints. We also show an estimation strategy that involves a variation of impulse-response matching and accounts for the lack of historical data concerning the conduct of macroprudential policy, a common problem.

Teaching experience

July 2019 – Dec. 2019 **Budapest University of Technology and Economics** Budapest, Hungary
Introduction to Multidimensional Time Series Analysis

- Introduction to VARs: Bayesian VARs and Structural VARs

Jan. 2019 – June 2019 **Eötvös Loránd University, Eltecon** Budapest, Hungary
Introduction to Macroeconomics

- Introduction to theories of business cycles IS-LM and the model of aggregate supply and demand
- Introduction to theories of long-run growth, the Solow model and the endogenous growth model

Work Experience

June 2017 – October 2020 **Central Bank of Hungary (MNB)** Budapest, Hungary
Applied Research Department
Analyst

Research projects:

- DSGE framework of macroprudential regulation
- Macro effects of Funding for Lending Schemes – via Bayesian SVARs
- Effects of bank capital requirements on lending activity – via panel methods

October 2016 – June 2017 **Central Bank of Hungary (MNB)** Budapest, Hungary
Macroprudential Policy Department
Junior Analyst

Research projects:

- Bank efficiency measurement across Central and Eastern Europe – via Stochastic Frontier Analysis

Operational tasks:

- Assisted the development of the yearly Macroprudential and Financial Stability report
- Assisted the fine-tuning of Loan-to-Value (LTV) and Debt-to-Income (DTI) regulation

Scholarships

DAAD – GSSP doctoral scholarship, full funding for the duration of the Ph.D.
Partial tuition waiver for Barcelona Graduate School of Economics (2015-2016)

Other Skills

Computer Skills	R, Matlab, Julia, Stata, Latex
Languages	English (fluent), Hungarian (native)

Conferences and Workshops

XXVIII Workshop on Dynamic Macroecnonomics, 2025/06
2nd Frankfurt Summer School, Deutsche Bundesbank, 2025/08

Advances in SVAR and DSGE models, BP school for central bankers, 2019/3
Bayesian Time Series Methods: Introductory, Advanced, BGSE, 2019/2
Economic modelling and forecasting, Bank of England, 2018/4
Financial Sector Surveillance, Joint Vienna Institute, 2018/1